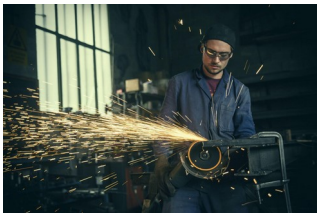
# Practical Bible Study (including 2.0)

Luke Johnston's selected teaching, writing or development sample; original bylines and citations retained.

## Full teaching files

| | |
|---|---|
| James lesson student copy | *2 pages* |
| James lesson teacher copy | *2 pages* |
| 1 timothy final | *2 pages* |
| acts 2 teacher copy | *2 pages* |
| Final Copy of PRACTICAL BIBLE STUDY 2.0- COLOSSIANS 318-25 | *1 pages* |
| james finished teacher | *2 pages* |
| song of solomon finished | *2 pages* |
| Song of Solomon student | *2 pages* |
| practical bible study 2 | *2 pages* |
| practical bible study 2(2) | *1 pages* |
| practical bible study 4 | *2 pages* |
| practical bible study acts 2 38 | *1 pages* |
| practical bible study student 1 john 5 7 | *1 pages* |
| practical bible study student acts 2 verse 38 | *1 pages* |
| practical bible study student james 2 | *1 pages* |
| cherubim and seraphim | *2 pages* |
| practical bible study 1 | *5 pages* |
| practical bible study student rev 4 | *1 pages* |
| practical bible study student ephesians 1 | *1 pages* |

Teacher and student editions are components of this one portfolio entry.



Wednesday, April 27th, 2022- EDGE YOUTH

# *Perfecting Our Faith-* ***James 2:14-26***

1. These verses we find in James are often wrested by many false teachers to say something that they do not mean. The truth is, these verses are found in a very challenging letter, written to suffering Christians, in order to urge them to press on doing the right things, and to separate the true followers from the fakes (as persecution does). When we see these verses in the correct light, **comparing scripture with scripture,** we will be blessed and challenged by God in amazing ways to _____ ____ _____ and not lose confidence in our faith (as those who wrest these scriptures would have us do).

2. **FAITH, FAITH, AND MORE FAITH**
    a. There are many different types of faith in the Bible. Not all apply to us "being saved" and our saving faith in Jesus and what he did on the cross and after.
        i. The faith by which we _____
            1. 2 Timothy 4:7; Col. 2:6-7; Rom. 14:1
        ii. The faith by which we received the gift of _____
            1. Gal 1:23; 2:16
        iii. Faith as described in Hebrews 11:1 (faith in its simplest form, the word "faith")
            1. Matt. 6:30; 8:10,26; 9:2, etc…

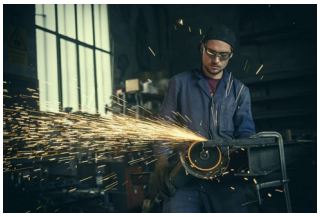
3. **"FAITH MADE PERFECT"**
    a. From all we know about salvation in the Bible, can we "perfect" our saving faith? _____
        i. **Gal. 3:3- "Are ye so foolish? having begun in the Spirit, are ye now made perfect by the flesh?"**
        ii. John 3:16; Rom. 10:9-10; Eph. 2:8-9
    b. If we cannot perfect our saving faith, we must be able to perfect another type of faith. The faith he is talking about is the faith we walk in after we are saved.
        i. Jam. 1:3-4; Eph. 4:13; 1 Thess. 3:10

4. **Where the rubber meets the road**
    a. We cannot simply write off the words of James. These are sound words and they need to cause us to reevaluate our lives and fix what needs fixing (James 1:22-25)
    b. Where is your faith today?
        i. Do you have THE saving faith by which we are made right with God through Jesus Christ?
            1. Ephesians 2:8-9- This faith is how we receive the grace
            2. John 3:16; Romans 10:9-10- This is how we receive this gift THROUGH faith
        ii. Are you walking in Christ as you received him? (by _____)
            1. We CANNOT live our Christian lives successfully outside of faith. We walk in Christ by faith for our entire Christian lives.

a. **Rom. 10:17-** “So then faith cometh by hearing, and hearing by the word of God.”
    i. How much time are you spending in the word of God? This is where we get faith, and where we can exercise faith by believing and obeying what God’s word tells us to do.
b. **James 1:5-6-** “If any of you lack wisdom, let him ask of God, that giveth to all men liberally, and upbraideth not; and it shall be given him. But let him ask in faith, nothing wavering. For he that wavereth is like a wave of the sea driven with the wind and tossed.”
    i. Are you praying to God in faith? Do you believe when you ask God for something that he can/will do it?
c. **Heb. 11:6-** “But without faith it is impossible to please him: for he that cometh to God must believe that he is, and that he is a rewarder of them that diligently seek him.”
    i. Without faith it is _____ to please God, so are you pleasing to God?

2. Are you perfecting your faith by showing your faith by your works?
    a. James tells us that our faith is shown by our works. As we perfect our faith, we ought to have works that much up more and more to what we profess to believe.
        **i. 2 Tim. 3:16-17**

5. As we have seen today, there are many types of faith in the bible. All are important and so it is of utmost importance that we understand them. We MUST have faith to be fruitful and glorifying to God in our lives. The faith that saves us is just the beginning, we have whole lives to live for God that require us to have faith each day. This faith must be _____ as we are sanctified and conformed to the image of Jesus Christ more and more each day.



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1. These verses we find in James are often wrested by many false teachers to say something that they do not mean. The truth is, these verses are found in a very challenging letter, written to suffering Christians, in order to urge them to press on doing the right things, and to separate the true followers from the fakes (as persecution does). When we see these verses in the correct light, **comparing scripture with scripture,** we will be blessed and challenged by God in amazing ways to "perfect our faith" and not lose confidence in our faith (as those who wrest these scriptures would have us do).

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        iii. Faith as described in Hebrews 11:1 (faith in its simplest form, the word "faith")
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3. **"FAITH MADE PERFECT"**
    a. From all we know about salvation in the Bible, can we "perfect" our saving faith? **NO!**
        i. **Gal. 3:3- "Are ye so foolish? having begun in the Spirit, are ye now made perfect by the flesh?"**
        ii. John 3:16; Rom. 10:9-10; Eph. 2:8-9
    b. If we cannot perfect our saving faith, we must be able to perfect another type of faith. The faith he is talking about is the faith we walk in after we are saved.
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# PRACTICAL BIBLE STUDY 2.0- 1 TIMOTHY 3:1-13

1. **Who** is writing/Who are they writing to/**When** are they writing?

   Paul is writing to his disciple and commissioned pastor Timothy around the year 63-65 AD

2. What is the **context** of this verse/passage/book?

   This letter is the first of Paul's two letters to his most well know disciple Timothy. He is writing after the time of Acts 28, between his 1st and 2nd Roman imprisonments. Paul speaks in this letter to Timothy about how a local NT church should operate, the leadership, and the members (1 Tim. 3:15). He deals with how to deal with heresy in chapter 1, orderly church behavior in chapter 2 and 3, and then our daily Christian living in chapters 4-6. This letter teaches us about a model disciple: one who is faithful, grows, becomes a sent out pastor/leader of a church, and desires to lead it well and the way the Bible teaches us to. He deals with specific issues such as: sound doctrine, prayer, men/women roles in the church, purity, personal holy conduct, sharing the gospel, false doctrines/teachers, how to treat elderly members of the church, servants and masters, riches and contentment, etc... This letter really has all we need to be model disciples from the time we are saved all the way to starting and ordering a church if God calls us to.

3. What is happening **historically?**

   Paul writes to his beloved disciple about, a young pastor, to detail the order and conduct of a local NT church. In our specific passage, he writes about the necessary character qualities for a bishop/elder/deacon (church leadership). He outlines the only 2 offices in the NT local church: pastors and deacons (pastors are also called bishops and elders)

4. What is the **doctrinal** (in context biblical truth) teaching here?

   Doctrinally, this passage teaches us about the character qualities that are required for a pastor or a deacon in the church. We learn that God is not interested as much in the orators, knowledgeable, charismatic leaders but those that have CHARACTER. God can use any man as a leader that has character. God's leaders of his church are REQUIRED to have these character qualities in their lives. If we see discrepancies in what God has said and who is in leadership, there is an element of grace and understanding BUT we need to evaluate based on God's clear standards he gives us. Doctrinally, we understand that bishops/elders/pastors are all the same office (Titus 1:5,7) We would be 100% okay to use bishop and elder as terms for pastors, however we don't due to the way they have been perverted by false religions. We also see almost an identical copy of this letter and the character qualities listed in Titus (another disciple/pastor of Paul's) that we can compare this letter to.

5. Is there any **prophetic** teaching here?

   There are many passages in the NT that do NOT contain prophesy unless it is plainly stated. There does not seems to be a deeper prophetic teaching in this passage that is clear. I am sure you could find some though if you looked hard enough and make enough connections. We can definitely see the breakdown of this order in the local church today, with added offices, women in leadership positions, men who have no business in leadership but are put there anyway, etc...

6. What can you apply **devotionally** from this?

   Devotionally we can and should ALL APPLY these principles of living. This is NOT a standard only for God's leadership "elite" but for all of us in the local church. We have to be living this way BEFORE we can ever be in a position of leadership in the church and we NEVER KNOW when God might call us to that place; are we ready for it and living ready for it if he calls?

7. What other **cross references** apply to this passage?

   Titus 1-3; Jeremiah 2:8; 3:15; 10:21; 12:10; 17:16; 22:22; 23:1-2; Luke 22:66; Acts 20:17, 28; Eph. 4:11-13;1 Pet. 4:9; 1 Pet. 5:1-3; Prov. 31:4-7; Eph. 5:18; Acts 6:3

8. What **word**/phrase studies did you do in this passage?

   elder, bishop, pastor, deacon, shepherd, wine, strike, lucre, etc...

9. What **consistent** patterns is God using in this passage to help you understand it/make connections?

   God shows us the pattern of bishops/elders/pastors all being the same thing in places such as Titus 1:5,7 and 1 Peter. 5:1-3. We see the "higher standard" to which God's leaders are called also throughout the Bible in places such as Prov. 31:4-7

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# PRACTICAL BIBLE STUDY 2.0- ACTS 2:1-13

1. **Who** is writing/Who are they writing to/**When** are they writing?

   Luke: writing to Teophilus a student/peer of some sort that was interested in the details of the church from Christ to the early church (Luke 1: 1-3) He wrote this around 65-70 AD

2. What is the **context** of this verse/passage/book?

   The book as a whole is a TRANSITIONAL BOOK. This is key to understand. The book before it ends with Jesus Christ and his twelve disciples and then the book following it starts with the Apostle Paul. Without Acts we have no idea about him, his story, his KEY position in the NT as it pertains to doctrine and Jesus Christ's ministry he gave Paul. Some key transitions in this book are: Jew to Gentile, Israel to the church, Kingdom of Heaven to the Kingdom of God, Peter to Paul, Jerusalem to Antioch, etc... Everything is changing as a result of Jesus death/resurrection and the rejection of the Messiah by Israel in the gospels and beginning parts of Acts. The book is a historical record of events, not a doctrine treatise. It gives multiples accounts of how to be saved at different points and the only consistent thing about the book, is that it is inconsistent. The previous chapter details the ascension of Christ and his commands to his disciples to go to Jerusalem FIRST.

3. What is happening **historically?**

   Luke is writing about the when the Apostles are at Jerusalem as Jesus told them to be and they are "waiting for the Holy Ghost" as they were told to do. They are to go to ISRAEL FIRST (Acts 1:8; Matt. 28:18-20; Lk. 24:47-49). They are at Jerusalem during the major Jewish holiday of Pentecost for the feast and festivities, when there are a million or more Jews in the area for the celebration. This is when the Holy Ghost first comes to the Apostles and gives them the power to preach and the SIGNS that are REQUIRED for JEWS to believe. They are preaching repentance for the murder of the Messiah (vs. 22-36) and they are doing signs to prove the message as the Bible says Jews are to looks for (1 Cor. 1:22; Acts 7:37; 3:22; Exo. 7-9; Acts 2:5)

4. What is the **doctrinal** (in context biblical truth) teaching here?

   Miracles/Signs purpose were to convince unbelieving Jews of the message being from God and God's spokesperson. Signs were NEVER about being signs of extra spirituality, salvation, given to all people to use/not use at their own power/discretion. They were given from God, by the power of his spirit to convince unbelieving Jews by the signs he told them to look for. Also they always WORK and people UNDERSTAND THEM and know that they are miracles (vs. 11-12) They are given to the Jews who had the savior who died to pay for their sin as promised in the OT, and now they are being offered the Kingdom on earth they were always promised if they would repent as a whole and receive Christ, the signs were to show absolute proof this was from God, yet they rejected as a majority.

5. Is there any **prophetic** teaching here?

   During the end times, when God is working through the Jews again and about to bring in the Kingdom before the Day of the Lord/Last Days (vs. 17; Joel 2:28-32) God will use his Jewish witnesses to reach the Jewish people through signs and wonders. Only this time they will receive him and he will come back and the prophesy in Joel will be fulfilled and finished as it was meant to be in Acts 2. (If they received him, the rest of the events would have happened/2nd coming and Jesus would have established his kingdom- Acts 2:16).
   "This is that" when you study it in the Bible typically means that it is a picture, metaphor, type of something else. In this case it was because Israel rejected Jesus still.

6. What can you apply **devotionally** from this?

   The Holy Ghost is the TRUE power in our lives. We don't need the signs/wonders in order to reach the world. We see people repent and come to receive Christ without any of these signs because the word of God is a greater sign! (1 Pet. 1:16-21; Psa. 19:7; Lk. 16:29-31; 1 Cor. 13:10)
   Live in repentance! Do not ever get the place where you are not repenting anymore because of the hardness of your heart. Repent when you know you are wrong, pride will lead to your destruction.

7. What other **cross references** apply to this passage?

   Luke 1:1-3; Acts 1:8; Matt. 28:18-20; Lk. 24:47-49; 1 Cor. 1:22; Acts 7:37; 3:22; Exo. 7-9; Acts 2:5; Joel 2:28-32; 1 Pet. 1:16-21; Psa. 19:7; Lk. 16:29-31; 1 Cor. 13:10

8. What **word**/phrase studies did you do in this passage?

   "this is that"; tongues; Pentecost; rushing wind; cloven

9. What **consistent** patterns is God using in this passage to help you understand it/make connections?

   "this is that" is a phrase meaning it is a type, picture, metaphor of something else. In our way of speaking we would assume it means that it is something else, but seeing the phrase usage in the Bible we see it has a different biblical definition. Usually dependent on the response of the hearers of the message of God, as is the case in Acts 2

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# PRACTICAL BIBLE STUDY 2.0- COLOSSIANS 3:18-25

1. **Who** is writing/Who are they writing to/**When** are they writing?

   Paul is writing to the church of believers at Colosi around 60 to 63 AD

2. What is the **context** of this verse/passage/book?

   Keeping in mind that Paul is writing to the church during this time of grace, and during the church age to exhort, correct and warn this church in Colosi we understand that the context applies to our lives today. This is a Pauline letter to whom the mysteries of the church were revealed, during the dispensation of grace, and during the church. Another context application we get from this book is when we see that it is closely connected with Laodicea as he tells them to read this epistle that he wrote to colossi in Laodicea, and he tells the audience to read the letter from Colosi. When understood in context helps us to understand how this is connected with the time in which we live now. It also helps us to understand from the historical perspective that the area of Colossi was very similar in wealth, education, industry, and lifestyle to the place we live now. Specifically the instructions he is giving in chapter 3 and the verses we are looking at applied to people who lived during the church age who lived very similar to how we do and Paul connect it with Laodicea, deepening the understanding that we need to hear these very words today because these are things that we struggle with. It is also important to recognize the context of this specific passage within the book. So far Paul has shown us how Christ is all we need, and he is above all in the world. He has shown us how Jesus Christ is preeminent in the gospel, cross, creation, church, etc. and he has also warned this church against empty philosophy, religious, legalism, and man-made disciplines, such as science. He was warning them, because he said all of these are dangers against the pin of Christ. All of this leads into the passage in chapter 3, where Paul is telling us the Jesus Christ needs to be pent in all of our relationships . Always remember the theme when it comes to context. How does this passage relate to the theme that Jesus Christ is all in all and that he has everything we need!

3. What is happening **historically?**

   When we put all of the above together, we understand that first and foremost. Historically Paul is writing to a church in the area of Colosi around the time of 60 to 63 a A.D., which is also during the church age, which means that we can apply it directly. He is writing to encourage them about their completeness in Jesus Christ, and he confronts the false doctrines of human self-sufficiency that says that Jesus Christ was not sufficient for their ever need. We understand that these words have a very direct application to our lives today in multiple ways. First, because it is written to a church in the New Testament just like we are and then also because he associates it with the Laodicean Church which we know that we are doctrinally as well

4. What is the **doctrinal** (in context biblical truth) teaching here?

   The in context, actual biblical teaching of this passage is simply that this is the way that Christians during the church age ought to live into interact within these different relationships. These are direct command given by God for us to follow in the church age, and he very clearly tells us that our obedience or disobedience to these commands, is obedience or disobedience to him, and it will have an effect on our eternal reward.

5. Is there any **prophetic** teaching here?

   Because of the keywords that we find throughout this book in the context of this passage, referring to Laodicea, we can understand that doctrinally this is a letter that is also written directly to us (Laodicean church period). This is the deeper doctrinal meaning behind this book. Not many New Testament letters from Paul have a deeper doctrinal meaning outside of what he plainly says, but in this case, there is one that we can find.

   We also see that while it is simple, and it is not hard to understand, but it is plainly stated that we will receive the reward of the inheritance for obeying the command given in this passage. We see this in verse 24. This is still future and prophetic, and something that we believe by faith and therefore it cannot be ignored. Also, we see the warning prophetically for those who do not obey these commands in verse 25.

6. What can you apply **devotionally** from this?

   When we put together that this letter is not only written to church, age Saints, but also very directly to the period of church, history, in which we live, we understand that devotion, God intends for us to know and obey these commands. He knows that we struggle with submission. There are many different devotions that can be applied from this passage to all people in all walks of life. The overarching devotional is that we need to be submissive, and we need to be obedient to these commands, because it directly affects our relationship with God and our rewards in eternity.
   - Husbands need to love their wives
   - Wives need to submit to their husbands (spiritually and physically))
   - Children need to obey their parents (spiritually and physically)
   - Servants need to obey their masters in the flesh (spiritually and physically)

7. What other **cross references** apply to this passage?

   Ephesians 5:21-6:9; 1 Cor. 11:3; Genesis 28:7; 1 Peter 3:1-6; Genesis 2:23-24; 1 Peter 3:7; Genesis 28:7; Exodus 20:12; Proverbs 6:20; 3:12; 4:1-4; 7; 1 Thess. 2:11; 1 Timothy 6:1-2; Titus 2:9-10; Philemon; 1 Peter 2:18-19; Deut. 15:12-15; 24:14-15; Jeremiah 34:9-17; Revelation 2-3

8. What **word**/phrase studies did you do in this passage?

   Wife, wives, husband, child, parent, father, mother, servant, steward, master, as Christ

9. What **consistent** patterns is God using in this passage to help you understand it/make connections?

   The connection between being a servant, and being a steward; also the phrase as Christ, which reveals to us the reason that he is telling us to do these things which is our relationship with him being affected

# PRACTICAL BIBLE STUDY 2.0- JAMES 2:14-26

1. **Who** is writing/Who are they writing to/**When** are they writing?

   James the Apostle, the brother of John (1 of the 3 apostles to the Jews); he is writing to the early Christian Jews that were being persecuted for their faith around the year 40-42 AD

2. What is the **context** of this verse/passage/book?

   While James is writing to "saved" Jews (12 tribes), they did not know about the church even though they were a part of it (Eph. 2:16;3:1-7), the title " Christian" was likely something he never heard (this happened in Acts 11:26; he was killed 5 verse later in Acts 12:2), Peter and the other disciples still struggled with church age doctrine and salvation by grace through faith ALONE without works until Acts 15 (Acts 15; Gal. 2:11-16), the mysteries of the New Testament had not been revealed yet THROUGH PAUL from Christ, Paul was not even saved yet, and this letter is the earliest written letter in the New Testament (40-42 AD) All throughout the first part of the book of James he is encouraging them to prove their faith! Your faith is DEAD if there are no works to prove it, that is his point and the theme of the book "faith that works". If there are no works, your faith is dead (you probably aren't saved, it was a false conversion) or AT BEST you are fruitless and dead like a dead tree that bears no fruit.

3. What is happening **historically?**

   James is writing to the scattered saved Jews of the first century after the resurrection, encouraging them of the proper response to suffering and explaining the evidence of true saving faith. He is speaking without any knowledge from God through Paul about the church, body of Christ, NT salvation, Christianity, or ANY of the NT mysteries that are ESSENTIAL for us to know in the church age. These were revealed through Paul YEARS later as he transitioned into the church age as we know it today. We know that the Jews all struggled with these NT doctrines for a while and yet they all recognized Paul and the teachings he was given as being from God and they knew HE was the guy God was using to reveal NT doctrine (2 Pet. 3:15-16; Acts 10; Gal. 2:1-11; Eph. 3:3; 6:19; Col. 4:3) This lack of understanding and the timing of this letter though was NOT a mistake, God had a divine plan for it and was doing this for a deeper purpose. Historically, we must get the context and read this letter in light of that context of the CLEAR Pauline epistles and the doctrines they contain.

4. What is the **doctrinal** (in context biblical truth) teaching here?

   The in context biblical truth that this is teaching is that our faith is DEAD if it is not accompanied by works. We are either not saved or we are not going to bear any fruit, but we should definitely EXAMINE ourselves and work out our salvation in FEAR AND TREMBLING (Philippians 2:12) and if we have no works, we ought to be fearful and repent. Even in Ephesians 2 where we KNOW faith is all that is required for salvation (vs. 8-9) we are told that we are saved to produce good works (vs 10).
   Keeping in mind that this was written by a Jewish author, to the 12 tribes of Israel who were saved and who were on the run from Rome being persecuted, before any of the NT church doctrine was known or taught; this helps us to understand why it was worded in such a way as this.

5. Is there any **prophetic** teaching here?

   The prophetic teaching in this passage cannot be overlooked and is absolutely essential to understanding the passage/book. Understanding that James (a Jew) is writing to the 12 tribes (Jews) who have been saved (trust in Christ) during a time of tribulation, on the run from Rome, about proving their faith by their works; this clearly let's us know that prophetically this is about the tribulation period and how salvation willl work during this time. They will have anchor passages in Hebrews, Matthew, and Revelation (Rev. 12:17) and will understand that this is about them and about their salvation in light of those other books that are directly talking about/to them.
   The book of James only references Christ 2x (1:1; 2:1), references the OT 57x, mirrors the language of Christ's sermon on the mount, talks about wind tossed waves (1:6), withering grass and flowers under a burning sun (1:10-11), fire of iniquity (3:6), fountains of bitter and sweet water (3:11), fig trees and olive trees (3:12), sowing and harvesting of peace (3:18), early and latter rain before the husbandman returns (5:7), Job is mentioned (5:11, only mention in NT, picture of tribulation), Elijah is mentioned shutting up the heavens (5:17) just like he will during the tribulation, and the name James is the Greek form of the Hebrew name JACOB (all about trouble and tribulation with Jacob)

6. What can you apply **devotionally** from this?

   Devotionally, we understand that even though our salvation is NOT tied to our works as the NT Pauline letters make abundantly clear once God revealed these truths; we OUGHT to have works with our faith and we were made for good works! (Eph. 2:8-10) We LOVE the first verses of this scripture (vs 8-9) but many don't focus on vs 10 because it means we have to live out what we say we believe. You will be more secure in your salvation if you live out your faith, you DOUBT because you are DEAD and fruitless and you don't even see the evidence in your own life. Have faith that WORKS!

7. What other **cross references** apply to this passage?

   Eph. 2:8-10; Romans 3:20,28; 4:2; 10:9-10,13; 2 Tim. 1:9; Titus 3:5; Gal. 2:16; John 3:16; Rom. 5:1,9; 8:3; Job; 1 Kings 17:1; Rev. 11:6; Rev. 12:17; Eph. 2:16; 3:1-7; Acts 11:26; 12: 2; 15; Gal. 2:11-16; 2 Pet. 3:15-16; Acts 10; Philip 2:12; Col. 4:3; Gal. 2:1-11

8. What **word**/phrase studies did you do in this passage?

   faith, work, justify, Abraham, made perfect, etc...

9. What **consistent** patterns is God using in this passage to help you understand it/make connections?

   True, genuine, real faith will be accompanied by WORKS; if not, it is DEAD (false belief) or at best it is fruitless and you will doubt your whole life. Faith and works go together, even if we don't like it. This does not contradict Paul and his writings about salvation.

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# PRACTICAL BIBLE STUDY 2.0- SONG OF SOLOMON 2:7-13

1. **Who** is writing/Who are they writing to/**When** are they writing?

   Solomon is writing to his Shulamite bride around the year 1014 AD

2. What is the **context** of this verse/passage/book?

   Solomon is writing to his Shulamite bride who he loves deeply. When you look in the Bible you find out he cared about this bride deeply and it seems she is the same woman in the story in 1 Kings 1-3, the "Shunamite" who took care of David, who his brother tries to make him jealous over which Solomon kills him for. To give context, this is a love letter between Solomon and this special bride of his. She is a Gentile, she was 1 of 700 wives and 300 concubines of his, and yet THIS IS HIS SONG OF SONGS, TO HIS BRIDE OF BRIDES. There is no song of the 1,005 songs he wrote (1 Kings 4:32) which was like this song. This was different. It shows his true love for this special woman and her love for him in a personal and intimate way. It is located within the Poetical books and contains a lot of OBVIOUS metaphors which we take as metaphorical because of the fact it is clearly metaphorical.

3. What is happening **historically?**

   The love shown between a Shulamite shepherdess by King Solomon and the joys and heartaches of wedded love. He writes this song about their relationship and words exchanged, feelings had, and encounters between them.

4. What is the **doctrinal** (in context biblical truth) teaching here?

   This shows the true love that a husband and wife ought to have for one another in marriage. They should desire to be together and to spend time together and long for each other like this couple. This particular passage shows us the importance of showing love to each other through quality time and words of affirmation (they talk about longing to be together and he writes in in a love letter to her)

5. Is there any **prophetic** teaching here?

   This book/passage shows the intimate relationship between Jesus Christ and his (primarily) Gentile bride, the church (also each of us as individual believers). This passage particularly talks about the rapture call of Christ to his church and the metaphors surrounding it give us details concerning the events around the rapture.
   Fig Tree fruit- Israel is growing, fruitful, a nation again and growing as a NATION
   Tender Grapes- Directly connected with the fig tree and rapture call (all in vs. 13) we see the "grapes are tender" which always symbolizes and is connected with bloodshed, war, and blood in general in the Bible. Bloodshed surrounding Israel as a nation is a sign of this rapture call. It also happens in the spring according to vss. 11-12

6. What can you apply **devotionally** from this?

   I should long daily to spend time with God personally. While this book deals with Christ and his bride, it is also specific to individual believers relationship with him because of the 1 on 1 nature of this love letter. This passage teaches that I should long DAILY to spend time with him, be near him, close to him, learn about him, etc... Also that I should long for and desire his return at the rapture.

7. What other **cross references** apply to this passage?

   1 Kings 1:3, 15; 2:17, 21, 22; 4:32; Rev. 4:1; 1 Thess. 4:16; Eph. 5:22-33; 2 Cor. 11:2; Rev. 19:7-8; Matt. 24:9; Luke 21:17; Pro. 27:18; Gen. 7:11; 8:2; Isa. 24:18; 1 Kings 4:25; Prov. 27:18; Hos. 9:10; Joel 1:1-7; Micah 4:1-4; Matt. 21:19-21; 24:32; Mark 11:13-21; Luke 13:1-9; Isa. 63:3; Rev. 14:14-20

8. What **word**/phrase studies did you do in this passage?

   window*, fig tree, grape*, tender grape*, arise*

9. What **consistent** patterns is God using in this passage to help you understand it/make connections?

   God uses the pattern of A KING and his GENTILE BRIDE into the NT mysteries and shows us what this book is about doctrinally.
   He also teaches us about the order of heaven with windows and doors in it to show us this is the rapture call from heaven.
   God teaches us about the fig tree as Israel and also about tender grapes as blood shed and blood in general to show us the signs surrounding the end times and rapture

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# PRACTICAL BIBLE STUDY 2.O- Song of Solomon 2:7-13

1. **Who** is writing/Who are they writing to/**When** are they writing?

2. What is the **context** of this verse/passage/book?

3. What is happening **historically?**

4. What is the **doctrinal** (in context biblical truth) teaching here?

5. Is there any **prophetic** teaching here?

6. What can you apply **devotionally** from this?

7. What other **cross references** apply to this passage?

8. What **word**/phrase studies did you do in this passage?

9. What **consistent** patterns is God using in this passage to help you understand it/make connections?

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# PRACTICAL BIBLE STUDY

1) James Chapter 2, Verse 17
   - **a)** Context-
     - i) Who is writing?
       - (1) What do you know about James? Anything pertaining to who he was and who he was called to reach?
       - (2) Hint: Paul was the apostle to the Gentiles and James, Peter, and John were to the Jews (Gal. 2:8-9)
       - (3) Talk about how after Hebrews we have Hebrews, James, and John and Peter that write the General Epistles for this reason
     - ii) Who are they writing to?
     - iii) When are they writing? (dispensation)
     - iv) What is going on in the previous/following chapters?
     - v) What is the tone of this book in terms of who he is writing to?
     - vi) Are there doctrinal implications of this book that effect the way it is written?
     - vii) Historical, Doctrinal, Devotional
     - viii) Mention that we have notes with this information and we will give to you if you want them
   - **b)** READ WHOLE PASSAGE (James 2:14-26)
   - **c)** Some people read this passage and use it to teach that you must live a good life and add "works" to your faith or else you are not saved or can lose your salvation
   - **d)** First thing you want to consider with one like this is what exactly is this saying
     - i) Does it say "without works you are not saved"?
     - ii) Or Does it say "without works you can lose your salvation"?
       - (1) The bottom line is that this passage is very unclear in terms of what it is talking about.
       - (2) There are multiple kinds of faith talked about in the Bible, what kind of faith is being talked about here?
     - iii) Do we know exactly what this means when it says your faith is dead?
       - (1) Does that mean non existent?
       - (2) Does it mean unfruitful?
     - iv) KEY: We already established that although this book is written to believers, it was written to Jewish believers directly after the death and resurrection of Christ, by a guy who was sent as an apostle to the Jews, was a Jew himself, and grew up Jewish. It has a tribulation context and is not written by the Apostle to the Gentiles and the head figure of NT doctrine (Who am I talking about?) PAUL
     - v) With all of this in mind, we want to go to clear passages of scripture that we have no doubt about what they are saying FIRST, and then use those to define this
       - (1) What are some clear passages of scripture about how to be saved?
       - (2) John 3:16; Romans 10:9-10, 13; 3:28; Ephesians 2:8-9; Galatians 2:16; Rom. 4:1-2 along with Romans 5:1

**e)** Now that we have established the CLEAR biblical teaching on this subject, we can now define what James is saying, within the context which he said it, and understand exactly what it means for us.

i) We now know that this is not saying that faith without works is not existent. That is to say that we know it is not saying that without works you are not saved or you are not in the faith.

ii) What is the teaching here for us then?

**f)** Now that we have discovered exactly what this means for us, the next natural question might be why did God say it this way?

i) Consider the context of what we are reading and the other areas of time that we said it applies to

ii) Talk about dual application

iii) Talk about the dispensations chart on the board

**g) Review the rules of bible study we used**

i) Context

ii) Clarity

iii) People Group

iv) Time Period

v) Application

vi) Every Word/Event

vii) Comparing Scripture

viii) Consistency (law of first mention)

ix) Literal

x) Confirmation

**h) Review running list of cross references we used**

**i) Any questions?**



# PRACTICAL BIBLE STUDY

1) Ephesians Chapter 1, Verses 3-6
   - **a)** Context-
     - i) Who is writing?
     - ii) Who are they writing to?
     - iii) When are they writing? (dispensation)
     - iv) What is going on in the previous/following chapters?
     - v) Historical, Doctrinal, Devotional
     - vi) Mention that we have notes with this information and we will give to you if you want them
   - **b)** READ WHOLE PASSAGE (Eph. 1:3-6)
   - **c)** Some people read this passage and use it to teach that God predestinates/chooses those who will/won't be saved
     - i) When you run into issues doctrinally, you find out that a lot of the time, they are defining words/terms incorrectly based on how they are privately interpreting the bible and not based on how the bible uses terms
   - **d)** Defining terms/phrases (use example of "world" earth, and "world" in John 3:16)
   - **e)** What are some key words/phrases you think we should define?
     - i) Holy
       - (1) There are over 600 references to holy, so does anyone know of any key verses pertaining to us living holy lives that can help trim that list down?
       - (2) Lev. 20:7; 1 Pet. 1:15-16
     - ii) Without blame
       - (1) What is another word for without blame? Blameless
       - (2) Phil. 2:15; 1 Thess. 5:23
         - (a) What are some words that keep showing up in these verses? (sanctified, sanctification) These words are always about becoming holy, sanctified, more like Christ, more like God, etc…. not about being saved!
         - (b) Is there any mention of salvation anywhere in these verses? Saved, justified, salvation, etc..? any?
     - iii) Predestinated (predestin*)
       - (1) Rom. 8:29 (conformed)
       - (2) Rom. 12:1-2 (living more for God, more sacrificial, not being in the world, being sanctified, being holy, set apart, etc…)
   - **f)** **Review the rules of bible study we used**
     - i) Context
     - ii) People Group
     - iii) Time Period
     - iv) Application
     - v) Every Word/Event
     - vi) Comparing Scripture
     - vii) Consistency (law of first mention)
     - viii) Literal
     - ix) Confirmation
   - **g)** **Review running list of cross references we used**
   - **h)** **Any questions?**



# PRACTICAL BIBLE STUDY

1) 1 John Chapter 5, Verse 7

**a)** Context-

i) Who is writing?

(1) What do you know about John? Anything pertaining to who he was and who he was called to reach?

(2) Hint: Paul was the apostle to the Gentiles and James, Peter, and John were to the Jews (Gal. 2:8-9)

(3) Talk about how after Hebrews we have James, and John, and Peter that write the General Epistles for this reason

ii) Who are they writing to?

iii) When are they writing? (dispensation)

iv) What is going on in the previous/following chapters?

v) What is the tone of this book in terms of who he is writing to?

vi) Are there doctrinal implications of this book that effect the way it is written?

vii) Historical, Doctrinal, Devotional

viii) Mention that we have notes with this information and we will give to you if you want them

**b) READ WHOLE PASSAGE (1 John 5:1-12)**

**c)** Defining Terms:

i) Most of this passage is self explanatory, however in the context of what John is trying to convey, what key word do we maybe need to define here? (WORD)

(1) John 1:1-14; Hebrews 4:12-14; Rev. 19:13

**d) 2 KEY DOCTRINES FOUND IN THIS VERSE/PASSAGE**

**e)** What are 2 key doctrines that we find in this verse/passage?

i) These verses are clearly teaching that Jesus Christ is God and that he is a part of this Godhead (3 parts of God)

ii) Lets do some bible cross referencing and study and see whether these things are so; give at least 3 references to prove each point

(1) God is a 3 part being made up of the Father, Jesus Christ, and the Holy Ghost (Gen 1:16; 11:7; Matt. 3:16-17; 2 Cor. 13:14)

(2) Jesus Christ is fully God/ equal with God (Jn. 10:30; Col. 2:9; John 1:1-14; 1 Tim. 3:16; Jn. 14:9-10; 17:21)

**f) 2 BONUS QUESTIONS WE CAN CONSIDER**

i) Are they all equally God?

(1) Yes, refer to verses about the trinity

ii) Are they all equal in authority?

(1) No they aren't, the Bible does teach us a hierarchy of authority to the Godhead much like there is even within our own person

(a) 1 Cor. 3:23; 11:3; 15:28

**g) Review the rules of bible study we used**

i) Context

ii) Clarity

iii) People Group

iv) Time Period

v) Application

vi) Every Word/Event

vii) Comparing Scripture

viii) Consistency (law of first mention)

ix) Literal

x) Confirmation

**h) Review running list of cross references we used**

**i) Any questions?**



# PRACTICAL BIBLE STUDY

1) The Acts of the Apostles Chapter 2, Verse 38

**a)** Today we will be getting into groups and working this passage out all on our own with the guidance of your other leaders. We will then get back together and share what we have found.

**b) KEY THINGS TO BE READY TO SHARE**

i) Context- Give us all that you found that pertains to context

ii) What does the verse actually mean AND what does it NOT mean?

(1) Give references

iii) What rules of bible study did you use?

**c) KEY THINGS TO CONSIDER/HINTS**

i) **CONTEXT is very important here:**

(a) Remember the bleeding in and out of dispensations (talk about transitional books)

(b) The 2 preceding verses in this passage will help a lot

ii) **THE CLARITY FACTOR AND COMPARING SCRIPTURE FACTOR are very important here**

(a) What are these 2 rules?

iii) **I would look at the phrase "remission* sin*" in your BLB app**

(a) Check where it is written that applies directly to us (Acts 8-Philemon)

**d) Review the rules of bible study we used**

i) Context

ii) Clarity

iii) People Group

iv) Time Period

v) Application

vi) Every Word/Event

vii) Comparing Scripture

viii) Consistency (law of first mention)

ix) Literal

x) Confirmation

**e) Review running list of cross references we used**

**f) Any questions?**



# PRACTICAL BIBLE STUDY

## 1 JOHN CHAPTER 5, VERSE 7



# PRACTICAL BIBLE STUDY

## THE ACTS OF THE APOSTLES CHAPTER 2, VERSE 38



# PRACTICAL BIBLE STUDY

## JAMES CHAPTER 2, VERSE 17

**Here are a few indisputable key facts when considering who the beasts are in Revelation chapter four:**

- You will never be able to find a mention of Cherub or Cherubim with any description of them that matches up with the description of the four beasts in Revelation chapter four.
- In order to try to make the four beasts in Revelation chapter four Cherubim you will have to assume that either John or Ezekiel saw and then wrote their description incorrectly under the inspiration of the Holy Ghost. Some people have a problem with this statement but it is simply true. You cannot approach the Revelation given to John or the vision given to Ezekiel assuming that every thing they wrote was correct as pertaining to what is actually in heaven if you think that both are Cherubim. There is an absolute truth of what is in heaven. That is if you were to ask God to give you a description of Cherubim or Seraphim or the four beasts, there is the absolute truth of what they actually look like in reality. You cannot assume that Ezekiel and John got that absolute truth correct and say that the Cherubim are the four beasts in Revelation chapter four.
- You CAN 100% assume that every detail Ezekiel, Isaiah, and John wrote in all of their Revelations were 100% correct under the inspiration of the Holy Ghost and preserved for us correctly today, when you believe that the beasts in Revelation chapter four are Seraphim.
- You cannot find any discrepancies between the description of the Seraphim in Isaiah chapter 6 and the four beasts in Revelation chapter four.
- To not believe that the beasts in Revelation chapter four are Cherubim creates no issues pertaining to any description given of Cherubim in the entire Bible. That includes their description, duties, position in relation to the throne, etcetera…
- To explain away the differences between Cherubim and the four beasts in Revelation chapter 4, you will have to go to other more obscure passages with vague details. You will have to ignore the clear detailed visions of Ezekiel specifically of what the throne and its surroundings look like and go to passages that have vague descriptions of “God dwelling between Cherubim” or the descriptions of the ark of the covenant. This is against the keys of Bible study.

| SERAPHIM | CHERIBUM | REV. 4 BEASTS |
|---|---|---|
| WINGS- 6 (Isa. 6:2) | WINGS- 4 (Eze. 1:6,11; 10:21-22) | WINGS-6 (Rev. 4:8) |
| FACES- 1 (Isa. 6:2 "face") | FACES- 4 EACH (Eze. 1:6-11; 10:14, 21) | FACES- 1 (Rev. 4:7) |
| WHAT THEY SAY- "HOLY, HOLY, HOLY" (Isa. 6:3) | WHAT THEY SAY- "...." | WHAT THEY SAY- "HOLY, HOLY, HOLY" (Rev. 4:8) |
| WHEELS- 0 | WHEELS- 4 (Eze.1:15-21; 10:6, 9-13) | WHEELS- 0 |
| WHERE THEY ARE- above the temple, which is also where the throne is (Isa. 6:1-2) "his train filled the temple. Above it stood the seraphims:" | WHERE THEY ARE- under the firmament which is under the throne (Eze. 1:22-26; 10:1) | WHERE THEY ARE- in the midst of and round about the throne (Rev. 4:6) |
| Lion, Calf, Man, Eagle mentioned: NO | Lion, Calf, Man, Eagle mentioned: YES (Eze. 1:10; 10:14) | Lion, Calf, Man, Eagle mentioned: YES (Rev. 4:7) |

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|---|---|
| MATCH REV. 4 BEASTS | GREEN |
| DON'T MATCH REV. 4 BEASTS | RED |



# Practical Bible Study

1) Revelation Chapter 4
   - **a)** Context-
     - i) Who is writing?
     - ii) Who are they writing to?
     - iii) When are they writing? (dispensation)
     - iv) What is going on in the previous/following chapters?
     - v) Historical, Doctrinal, Devotional
     - vi) Example of Acts 2
     - vii) Mention that we have notes with this information and we will give to you if you want them
       - (1) Questions: What rules of Bible study have we used so far?
   - **b)** READ WHOLE PASSAGE (chapter 4)
   - **c)** Examine vs. 1-3
     - i) What does this sound like? Is this familiar to anyone? (rapture, end of the church age, immediately in the spirit and in heaven)
     - ii) We want to examine this in the bible and see where else it shows up
       - (1) Key words; voice trump* (search in blb)
       - (2) Tsk those verses and build cross references
       - (3) Any other bible examples of this rapture (Enoch, Noah, Lot)
   - **d)** Examine vs. 4
     - i) Who does this sound like? White raiment and crowns on their heads?
       - (1) Vs 10 later in the chapter
       - (2) Tsk the verse (rev. 20:4)
       - (3) Search (judgment was given) (these elders on thrones are saints)
       - (4) Does the bible talk anywhere else about saints (believers) being judges? (maybe use tsk on Daniel 7:22)
       - (5) Back to verse 4- Use concordance to show what “seats” these are (thronos)
         - (a) NOBODY TRULY KNOWS exactly who these guys are, some think they represent all saints in heaven (12 disciples and 12 tribes; 2 foundations) BUT should we take this literally? (ask to look at rules)
         - (b) We can and so we probably should, we don’t know who these 24 are but they are saints and we know that we are seated and look just like them somewhere in heaven at this point, we just aren’t sure where. Or maybe God is trying to tell us these are us (instead of saying “I saw 1,250,546,987 elders around the throne”)
   - **e)** Examine vs. 5-11
     - i) Example of self defining and why we read the whole passage first
       - (1) “and there were seven lamps of fire burning before the throne, which are the seven Spirits of God.”
     - ii) Sea of glass
       - (1) TSK- Rev. 15:2
       - (2) Where is this sea located? Where is John when he sees it? (heaven, specifically directly below Gods throne)
       - (3) Where else can we find this mass of water? Search (sea heaven)
         - (a) Rev. 21:1
       - (4) Anywhere else where we can find how this water got there?
         - (a) Gen. 1:6-8
       - (5) Why is it there? (It separates God from his sinful and judged creation, and when God has no more need of it he gets rid of it in Revelation 21 (context of these verses is God dwelling with man, no more separation)
     - iii) Four Beasts
       - (1) TSK verse 8- (Isa. 6:1-3; Eze. 1:4-10; Eze. 10:14-22)
       - (2) Search Cherub* in blb

(a) Talk about law of first mention
(b) Genesis (they guard the garden)
(c) Exodus (they cover/guard the ark of the covenant)

(3) The four beasts are Seraphim (Isaiah and John are the only to mention them), which are special creatures which are given extra wings to guard the throne of God in heaven. They praise God also in heaven, just as Isaiah and John both saw

(4) Their position in relationship to the throne is closer to that of Rev. 4; Ezekiel has them below where the throne is, below the firmament

(5) Cherub are NEVER found named in the Bible with any description that matches closely to that of the Rev. 4 beasts

(6) IF the cherubim match anything described in Rev. 4, by cross referencing, we can figure out that it would be the 7 spirits
(a) They are described as burning lamps (Rev. 4:5; Ez. 1:13)
(b) They are described as spirits (Rev. 4:5; Ez. 1:20-21; 10:17)
(c) They are around/before the throne (Rev. 4:5; Ez. 1:5)

(7) Review page attached about this subject

**f) Review the rules of bible study we used**

i) Context
ii) People Group
iii) Time Period
iv) Application
v) Every Word/Event
vi) Comparing Scripture
vii) Consistency (law of first mention)
viii) Literal
ix) Confirmation

**g) Review running list of cross references we used**

**h) Any questions?**

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| | |
|---|---|
| MATCH REV. 4 BEASTS | GREEN |
| DON'T MATCH REV. 4 BEASTS | RED |



# Practical Bible Study

## Revelation chapter 4



# PRACTICAL BIBLE STUDY

## EPHESIANS CHAPTER 1, VERSES 3-6